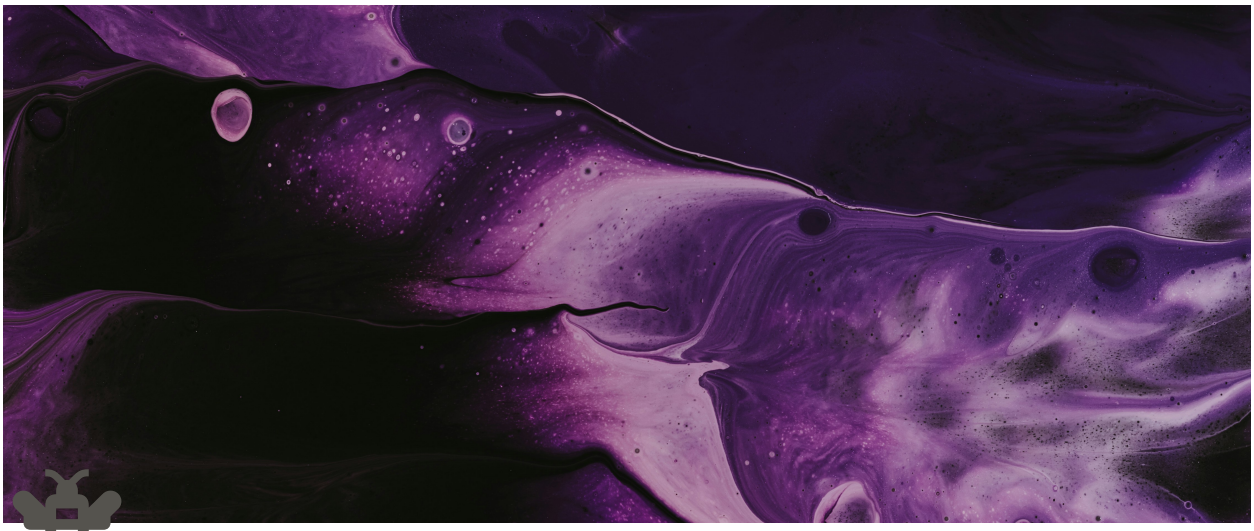


A2 - SIMULATIONS

GitRepo Here: https://github.com/miss-nibiru/HoudiniProjects

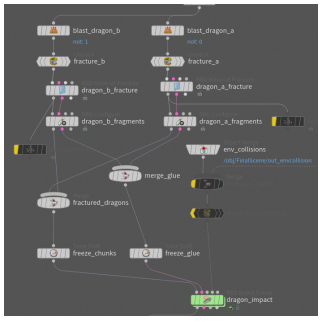
SUMMARY & PREFACE

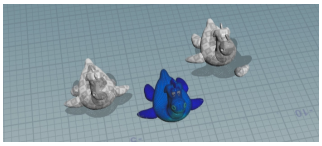
Pls don't make me keep using Houdini. Pretty please. Shaena, I'm really dying to say that this program is fun and procedural art is amazing - but it is definitely giving me a lot more issues and causing more headaches than it should. Probably a big issue is that I decided to go with VAT and it's definitely more crazy complicated;

PROCESS

RIGID BODY DESTRUCTION

I created the destruction in Houdini using rigid-body dynamics and exported it through VAT so the broken pieces could animate in Godot. The whole animation was cached and baked and ready to go and that was very useful. I'm sure I could do a bigger break if I just export the animation - Godot would update it and that's great!





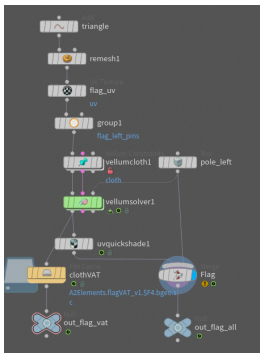
another big issue was Godot. And I hat8 myself sometimes when I *REALLY* want to try and learn something. I should chill my crazy goat, split-second decisions; I could be happier.

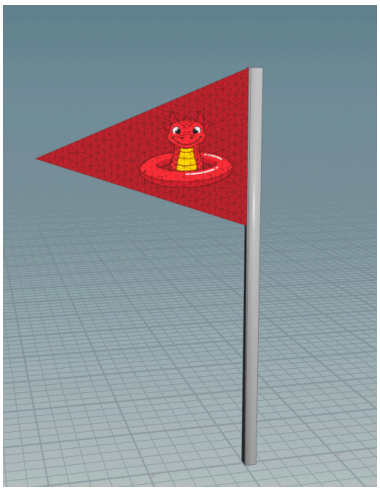
WELCOME TO MY SUPER FUN ~~NOT AT ALL BORING~~ DRAGON RACE!

For this assignment, I decided to take a quick inspiration in Mario Kart and created a pool dragon race. I loved that test thingy in Houdini, it looks really silly. It was really useful when I was feeling frustrated at least... they were incredibly ridiculous to look at.
It was a simple idea too, just these dragons racing around a super simple river, some flags waving (I made the logo myself). When the dragon that wins collides with the other dragons they break

VELLUM (FLAGS & FINISH RIBBON)

Used the same process as the dragons but using Vellum. When the dragon impacts the ribbon, it breaks in the middle :D



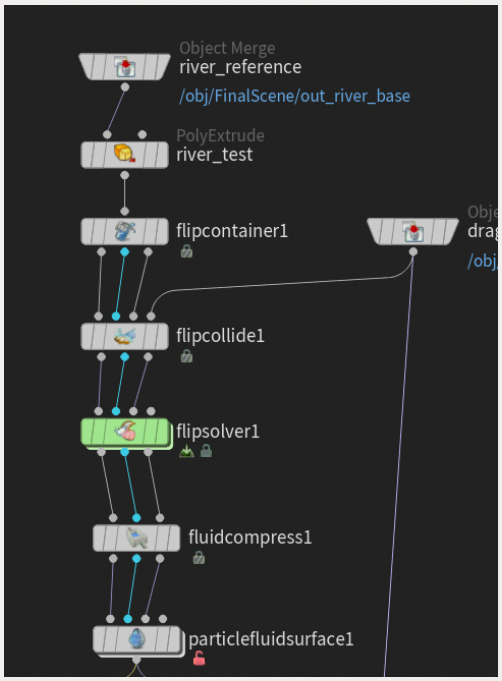


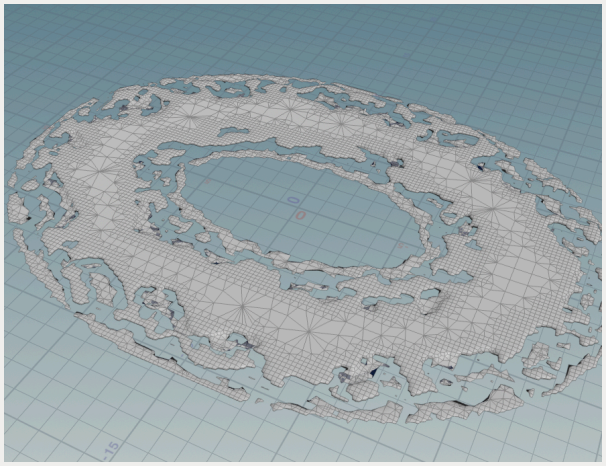
apart and then the finish line breaks. Again, simple and trying to be as cheap as possible - I swear my computer was going to take off at any time.
I think the final cinematic is kinda cute (the audio helps a lot); but dear Goddess, getting there was a SO frustrating.



THE WATER THAT DEFEATED ME

Oh boy. The water.
I'm not exaggerating when I say that I spent like 8 hours only trying to export the flip simulation from Houdini. It was a total nightmare and I just gave up. I am completely aware that this is part of the requirements and I'm aware I'm gonna get marks deducted but I swear, I was going crazy at that point and I had a dentist appointment.
The simulation exists and the caches are there. Watched a million videos to do the exports and I even ask the cursed AI to help me figure it out. Nothing I did was working and never worked and I quit.





FINAL CINEMATIC & AUDIO

For the animation/cinematic I ended up creating in Godot, I just found a quick shader that looks like water and added it where it's supposed to go in the river bank to at least salvage a little of what the race was supposed to be. And because I know I'm probably losing and insane amount of marks here, I decided to add some audio too! My husband helped me here with the announcer voice and everything else was downloaded from

pixabay still using Mario Kart as a reference. I also animated 7 cameras but I didn’t necessarily played around with the graph because we are not friends.

REFLECTION

Houdini really isn't for me. I very much understand what the program is capable of and it’s exciting to see things moving or being created out of 3 nodes. It is also not a hard program to understand and there’s a million thousand resources out there… but procedural 3D art and something so so so expensive does not align with the kind of studio I’m going to build or the games I want to make. I'm much more interested in 2D games and keep working on my alien parasite game. Low key felt that I was wasting time doing procedural when I have a whole metroidvania to make. I totalled around 50 hours on this project. I don’t think was worth it.

I like understanding simulations; I don't see myself using Houdini.